



Sanskar vs Stand up

By Suvarna Chauhan



A witty take on SDG 16, using humour to highlight free expression and the strength of a democracy that can laugh at itself.



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DISCLAIMER

This storybook is a work of satire and is intended purely for entertainment and reflection. It does not intend to target, offend, or disrespect any individual, religion, caste, community, political group, or institution. The purpose is to encourage dialogue through humor, not division.

Scene - Dinner table.
dal and democratic
tension are being
served hot

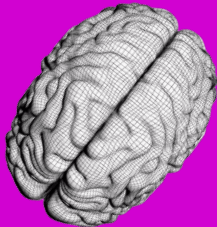
MEET THE CHARACTERS

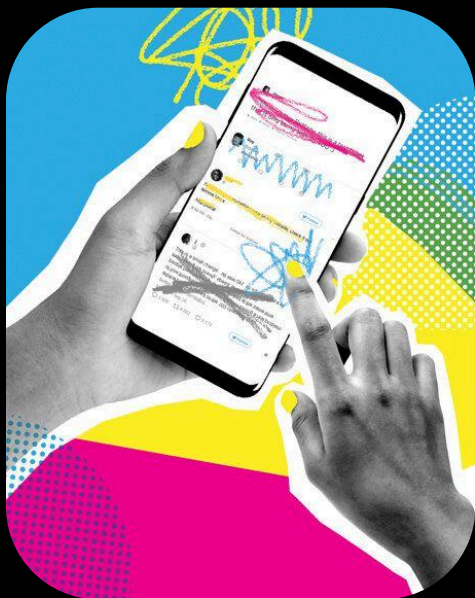
Mom -
WhatsApp University
Gold medalist



Dad -
News Channel Loyalist

Son -
Meme Lord in training





Son says
“So India’s Got Latent just
ghosted Samay Raina for
being too funny. Makes
sense—laughter is the
deadliest weapon after
free Wi-Fi.”

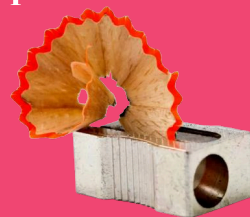




Dad: "Good! These comedians think they can say anything. What's next? Mimicking ministers during bhajans?"



Mom: "Samay Raina? That boy looks like he bunked school and never came back. Very suspicious energy."





Son: "Ma, he's not running from school, he's running from censorship. And did you hear? People vandalized Habitat in Mumbai over Kunal Kamra's parody song about Modi ji!"

Dad: "See! When you poke the lion, expect scratches."



Record Breaking



तानाशाह
oh तानाशाह

Son: "Scratch? Papa, the man sang a song, not started a civil war. Since when did jokes become a national security threat?"

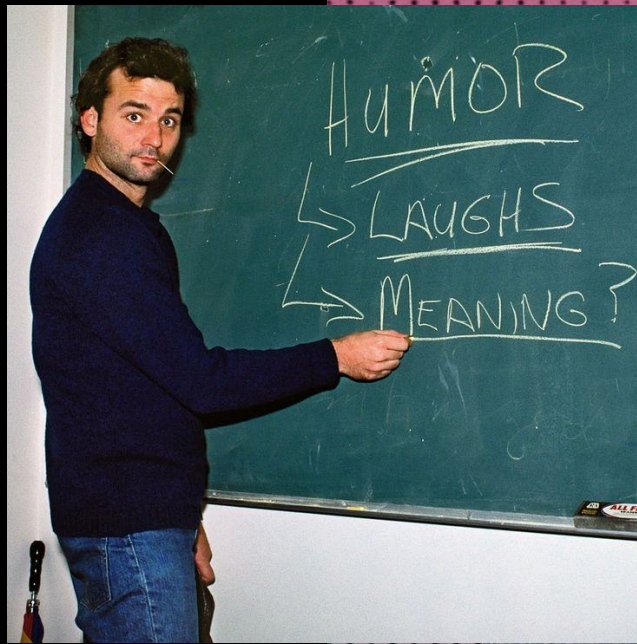


M A E R I C A



Son: "Exactly! And
part of our culture is
jugaad, democracy,
and chai pe charcha
— not chai pe FIR."





Dad: "Still, some topics are not for comedy."

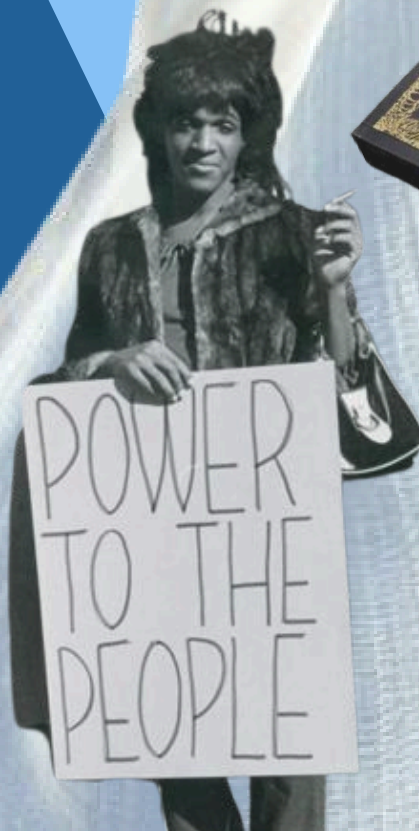
Son: "So what do we joke about? Weather? Oh wait, even that's controversial — one heatwave and half the news channels are blaming Pakistan's AC."





Mom: “And what is this SDG you keep talking about?”

Son: “SDG 16, Ma. Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions. Real strength isn’t banning comedians or breaking chairs in a comedy club. It’s laughing, learning, and maybe... fixing real issues instead of fake outrage.”





Dad: "So you're saying the nation needs... stand-up support?"

Son: "Exactly! Less breaking news, more breaking into laughter."

Mom: "Hmph. Just don't start parodying your father's snoring habits."

Son: "Already working on a song called 'Modi ji, Mummy ji & Middle-Class Misery'. Releasing this Friday, unless I get grounded first."



Ethics Check

A country that can't handle a joke needs more introspection than instruction. Strong institutions don't silence humor—they survive it. Peace isn't built by banning mics, but by building minds that can laugh, learn, and listen

Image source :
<https://in.pinterest.com/>
<https://www.cosmos.so/>

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~author

Suvarna Chauhan is a Master of Design student at NIFT Panchkula, with a keen interest in design, films, and the hidden meanings in everyday objects. She draws inspiration from metaphors, symbolism, images, and stories especially those found in news and culture. She enjoys thoughtful conversations around complex and often overlooked topics.



जनहित में जारी

